

Heuristic Evaluation

Structure of the individual report

Part I: Evaluator Info

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Part II: Project Description

Group: Fusion Destiny

The Problem To Be Solved: PLayering non-localized games.

Solution: For players who encounter culturally-rich games, provide a way to deliver context-aware and culturally-grounded translations, so that they can grasp the original narrative and artistic meaning without immersion-breaking confusion, unlike current literal or poorly localized translations, under constraint of real-time performance and seamless UI integration

Part III: Evaluation Execution

We met during the lab session and conducted the evaluation using the paper prototypes. I saw lots of effort, but the paper prototypes were a bit unfinished, made the explanation of the project (also the evaluation) harder.

The main tasks that we've evaluated were:

Simple Task: Play the game with translated text.

Moderate Task: Adapt part of the gameplay in a culturally aware way.

Complex Task: Users provide information or tips to the system to improve the translations

Part IV: List of Violations

Report the heuristics' violations you identified. Each of them must be numbered sequentially, formatted as follow:

1. H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use

Where: Initial setup – language selection list

What: The language list cannot be efficiently browsed because a scroll bar is missing.

Why: Without a scrollbar, users cannot quickly navigate long lists, reducing efficiency and forcing unnecessary manual search efforts.

Severity: 2

2. H5 Error prevention

Where: Initial setup – language selection list

What: The default language is not pre-selected.

Why: Users may accidentally pick the wrong language or feel uncertain about what the system expects. Preselecting the most likely option prevents unnecessary errors.

Severity: 2

3. H1 Visibility of system status

Where: Post-setup desktop screen

What: After setup, the system waits for user input, but the visible buttons do nothing.

Why: When actions have no feedback or effect, the system fails to communicate status, leaving users unsure whether the interface is frozen or functioning.

Severity: 3

4. H10 Help and documentation

Where: Main toolbar UI

What: The overlay pop-up toolbar lacks explanation and is unclear without outside instruction.

Why: The system does not provide sufficient guidance for users to understand the toolbar's purpose or functions, violating the need for accessible help.

Severity: 3

5. H2 Match between system and the real world

Where: Main toolbar UI

What: The "mix-mode" feature is difficult to understand.

Why: Terminology and function do not align with user expectations or real-world concepts, making the feature confusing and unintuitive.

Severity: 2

6. H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use

Where: User prompt page

What: The user must manually adjust prompt selections during every use; this becomes very time-consuming when many prompts exist.

Why: This reduces efficiency by forcing repetitive, non-optimized actions. The system does not support shortcuts, defaults, or saved preferences.

Severity: 3

7. H3 User control and freedom

Where: User input page

What: Users cannot type certain needed words because the keyboard language is restricted.

Why: Restricting keyboard language removes user control, preventing them from freely expressing intended input and forcing workarounds.

Severity: 4

8. H3 User control and freedom

Where: User input page

What: A “Hide” button is missing, limiting the user's ability to collapse or hide the input interface when desired.

Why: Users lack control over managing visibility or minimizing parts of the UI, restricting navigation and workflow freedom.

Severity: 2

9. H4 Consistency and standards

Where: Main interface – buttons on the toolbar and input areas

What: Several buttons do not have icons, relying only on text labels.

Why: Modern interfaces typically use recognizable icons to support quick recognition. Lack of icons reduces scannability, slows task performance, and makes the UI feel inconsistent with common standards.

Severity: 2

10. H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design

Where: Overall interface – visual design and layout

What: The UI appears outdated, with older-style layout, spacing, and visual elements.

Why: An outdated visual design reduces perceived usability and makes the system feel less trustworthy or modern. It also introduces visual clutter and fails to follow contemporary minimalist design principles.

Severity: 2

Part V: Summary and Recommendations

Report in the table below the total number of identified violations.

Heuristic	# violations
H1: Visibility of system status	1
H2: Match between system and the real world	1
H3: User control and freedom	2
H4: Consistency and standards	1
H5: Error prevention	1
H6: Recognition rather than recall	0
H7: Flexibility and efficiency of use	2
H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design	1
H9: Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors	0
H10: Help and documentation	1
HN: Non-heuristic issue	0

The idea of the project is interesting, but it solves a straightforward problem in a complex way. Many parts feel unfinished or require guesswork from the user. Several features aren't immediately understandable, which can make early interactions confusing. The system would benefit from clearer visual cues and a design that highlights what actions are possible at any moment.

In general, users should be able to move through tasks smoothly without repeating the same steps or feeling limited by the interface. Ensuring that all controls behave as expected and that the system responds consistently would make the experience feel more reliable and intuitive.

Improving the visual design and adding small aids (such as clearer icons, brief explanations, etc...) would go a long way toward making the interface more approachable. With a few adjustments focused on clarity and user control, the overall experience could become much easier and more enjoyable.